

AKANKSHA PAWAR

UX DESIGNER & INTERACTION SPECIALIST

pawarakanksha1628@gmail.com | behance.net/akankshapawar | Pune, Maharashtra, India

PROFILE & DESIGN PHILOSOPHY

Where research meets creativity, and ideas become experiences. Passionate UX designer and researcher specialized in human-centered systems, assistive technologies, and ethical AI interactions with a strong foundation in visual communication.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Product & UX Designer

2023 — Present

Ishaara & ASTRA Design Lab

- Spearheaded Ishaara (AR assistive learning system for autistic children) collaborating directly with therapists.
- Architected ASTRA interaction framework exploring ethical AI boundary-setting and intention cues.
- Built accessible component libraries and design tokens compliant with WCAG 2.2 AAA standards.

UX Researcher & Interaction Designer

2022 — 2023

Samsung Iris Connected Experience

- Conducted 24+ contextual inquiry interviews and synthesized cognitive walkthroughs for smart living interfaces.
- Designed tactile feedback models and multi-modal voice & visual interaction workflows.

Design Intern — Interaction & Visuals

2021 — 2022

Studio DesignCraft

- Created user journey maps, wireframes, and design system components for web and mobile apps.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design (B.Des)

Visual Communication & Interaction

MIT Institute of Design, Pune

2019 — 2023 | Distinction

HONORS & RECOGNITION

- Behance Featured UX Project (2024)
- Samsung Innovation Award Finalist (2023)
- MITID Best Graduation Project Nominee (2023)

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Design & UX: User Research, Contextual Inquiries, Interaction Design, Wireframing, IA, Usability Testing, WCAG 2.2, Ethical AI

Tools & Tech: Figma, FigJam, Adobe Creative Suite (Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects), Spline 3D, HTML/CSS, Protopie